

YIZHI SUN

Ph.D. in Statistics

Senior Data Scientist with a Doctor of Philosophy in Statistics possessing a solid theoretical and practical knowledge of modern statistics, machine learning and data mining in solving real world problems. I am a **Canadian Citizen**.



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Vancouver, BC, Canada

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Software and Programming languages:

Python (Including SciPy, NumPy, Pandas, Mathplotlib, scikit-learn), SQL, LLM, R, Hive, Airflow, Linux Shell, Git

Statistical Methods:

Exploratory Data Analysis, Linear and Generalized Linear Models, A/B Testing, Experimental Design, Bayesian Data Analysis, Time Series Analysis

Machine Learning:

Classification, Regression, Clustering, Anomaly Detection, Dimensionality Reduction, and Feature Engineering

EDUCATION

Ph.D., Statistics

Virginia Tech

09/2012 - 12/2018

MS, Statistics

Temple University

08/2010 - 05/2012

BS, Statistics

University of Science and Technology of China

09/2006 - 06/2010

WORK EXPERIENCE

Senior Data Scientist

Cvent

03/2021 - Present

Vancouver, BC, Canada

Achievements/Tasks

- Delivered actionable insights and data products by analyzing Cvent Event Cloud data, driving business growth.
- Designed an NLP-powered attendee interest engine using TextRank, extracting user interests based on past registrations.
- Enhanced the attendee interest engine by integrating search data, improving session recommendations' relevance by 20%.
- Leveraged large language models (LLMs) to develop event recommendations, achieving a 20% overlap rate.

Data Scientist

Suning USA

08/2019 - 08/2020

Palo Alto, CA, USA

Achievements/Tasks

- Built predictive models addressing loan overdue and fraud detection for Suning.com using Spark and XGBoost, improving operational efficiency.
- Developed a preliminary scoring model to guide the second-generation Loan Overdue Model.
- Created an anomaly detection system using Isolation Forest, achieving 80% precision in identifying misbehaving users across 1.2M records.

Data Scientist Intern

Airbnb

06/2017 - 07/2017

San Francisco, CA, USA

Achievements/Tasks

- Developed a feature comparison system to evaluate third-party signals for the chargeback model.
- Automated feature engineering pipelines using Apache Airflow and validated improvements with Random Forest models, boosting AUC from 0.710 to 0.713.
- Designed an online feature monitoring dashboard in Apache Superset to ensure production feature robustness.

Statistical Consultant

Virginia Tech

01/2014 - 05/2014

Blacksburg, VA, USA

Achievements/Tasks

- Collaborated with multidisciplinary researchers, simplifying complex statistical methodologies like regression and experimental design.
- Proposed and implemented a Poisson Mixed Effect Model using SAS to analyze biodiversity across paired water systems.
- Validated client hypotheses with significant results ($p\text{-value} < 0.01$), supporting data-driven conclusions.